

Post-Incident Report — VPN Outage

IT Team (Infrastructure & Support) - Infovance Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

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Owner: IT Team (Infra & Support)	Classification: Internal	Next review: Monthly IT Ops Review

Incident: Corporate VPN Outage — Gateway Certificate Expiry • **Severity:** P1 (Critical) • **Status:** Resolved / Closed
Date of incident: 06 January 2026 • **Prepared by:** Vikram Reddy (IT Manager) • **Reviewed by:** Information Security & Risk

1. Summary

On the morning of 06 January 2026, the corporate VPN gateway (vpn.infovance.com) became unavailable, preventing remote employees from establishing Cisco AnyConnect sessions. The outage lasted approximately 3 hours and affected an estimated 200 remote-working employees across all four departments. The root cause was an expired TLS server certificate on the VPN gateway. Service was restored after the certificate was renewed and the gateway services were reloaded. There was no evidence of any security breach or data loss.

2. Incident Timeline (IST)

Time	Event
08:05	First user reports of 'connection failed' on AnyConnect arrive via helpdesk@infovance.com and Jira Service Desk.
08:15	Helpdesk observes a spike in identical VPN tickets; issue flagged to Infrastructure on-call.
08:25	Incident declared P1 (Critical) — many users, no workaround, business-wide remote access impacted.
08:30	IT confirms the gateway is reachable but rejecting TLS handshakes; error points to an invalid/expired certificate.
08:45	Root cause confirmed: VPN gateway certificate expired at 00:00 on 06 Jan; auto-renewal had not fired.
09:10	Replacement certificate issued and validated.
09:40	Certificate installed on the gateway; staged config check.
10:05	VPN services reloaded; test connections from IT succeed.
10:25	Phased confirmation — users asked to reconnect.
11:05	Ticket volume back to baseline; incident marked resolved.
11:30	Comms sent confirming restoration; PIR scheduled.

3. Root Cause

The TLS server certificate on the primary VPN gateway expired. The certificate was on a manual/auto-renew arrangement that failed silently — the scheduled renewal job did not execute and no expiry alert was configured, so the certificate lapsed unnoticed. When clients attempted the TLS handshake, the gateway presented an expired certificate, which AnyConnect rejected, blocking all new VPN sessions. Existing long-lived sessions were unaffected until they renegotiated, which is why impact appeared gradually rather than all at once.

4. Impact Assessment

- Affected users:** ~200 remote employees unable to connect to internal systems for the duration of the outage.
- Duration:** ~3 hours (approx. 08:05 – 11:05 IST).
- Departments affected:** HR, IT, Finance, Engineering (remote staff).

- **Business impact:** Delayed access to internal applications, timesheets and code repositories for remote workers. On-site staff unaffected. No client-facing production systems went down; no SLA breaches reported.
- **Data/security impact:** None. No unauthorized access, data loss or breach — an availability-only failure.

5. Resolution Steps

- Identified the expired gateway certificate as the cause.
- Issued and validated a replacement TLS certificate.
- Installed the new certificate on the VPN gateway.
- Reloaded gateway services and verified the TLS handshake.
- Confirmed successful test connections from the IT team.
- Asked employees to reconnect; monitored ticket volume to baseline before declaring resolution.
- Sent an all-clear communication to staff.

6. Preventive Measures / Action Items

ID	Action	Owner	Due
P1	Automated certificate expiry monitoring + alerting for all gateways and critical services (alerts at 30/14/7 days)	IT Infrastructure	23 Jan 2026
P2	Maintain a central certificate inventory with owners and expiry dates; review monthly	IT Infrastructure	31 Jan 2026
P3	Verify and harden the auto-renewal job; add a failure alert that pages on-call	IT Infrastructure	23 Jan 2026
P4	Add a VPN-down runbook to Confluence and link it in the on-call rotation	IT Support	30 Jan 2026
P5	Staff reminder: use helpdesk/Service Desk (not DMs); report security incidents to security@infovance.com within 2 hours	IT Manager	Comms at all-hands

7. Sign-off

Prepared by Vikram Reddy (IT Manager); approved by Information Security & Risk. Lessons learned to be reviewed at the next monthly IT operations meeting.